



PHP Cookies

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What is a Cookie?

- A **cookie** is often used to identify a user.
- A **cookie** is a small file that the server embeds on the user's computer.
- Each time the same computer requests a page with a browser, it will send the cookie too.
- With PHP, you can both create and retrieve cookie values.

Create a Cookie

- A cookie is created with the `setcookie()` function.
- Syntax:

setcookie(**name**, value, expire, path, domain, secure, httponly);

- Only the **name** parameter is required.
- All **other parameters** are **optional**.

```
<?php
$cookie_name = "user";
$cookie_value = "John Doe";
setcookie($cookie_name, $cookie_value, time() + (86400 *
30), "/"); // 86400 = 1 day
?>
```

- **setcookie()** function must appear **BEFORE** the `<html>` tag.

Retrieve a Cookie

- Retrieve the value of the cookie "user" (using the global variable `$_COOKIE`).
- Use the **isset()** function to *find out* if the cookie is set:

```
<?php
if(!isset($_COOKIE[$cookie_name])) {
    echo "Cookie named '" . $cookie_name . "' is not set!";
} else {
    echo "Cookie '" . $cookie_name . "' is set!<br>";
    echo "Value is: " . $_COOKIE[$cookie_name];
}
?>
```

Modify a Cookie Value

- To modify a cookie, just **set** (*again*) the cookie using the **setcookie()** function:

```
<?php
$cookie_name = "user";
$cookie_value = "Alex Porter";
setcookie($cookie_name, $cookie_value, time() + (86400 *
30), "/");
?>

<html>
<body>

<?php
if(!isset($_COOKIE[$cookie_name])) {
    echo "Cookie named '" . $cookie_name . "' is not set!";
} else {
    echo "Cookie '" . $cookie_name . "' is set!<br>";
    echo "Value is: " . $_COOKIE[$cookie_name];
}
?>

</body>
</html>
```

Delete a Cookie

- To delete a cookie, use the **setcookie()** function with an *expiration date* in the past:

```
<?php
// set the expiration date to one hour ago
setcookie("user", "", time() - 3600);
?>

<html>
<body>

<?php
echo "Cookie 'user' is deleted.";
?>

</body>
</html>
```

Check if Cookie are Enable

- Count the \$_COOKIE array variable

```
<?php
if(count($_COOKIE) > 0) {
    echo "Cookies are enabled.";
} else {
    echo "Cookies are disabled.";
}
?>
```

References

- W3 Schools – [w3schools.com](https://www.w3schools.com)